Many of these orders were issued subsequently in Midnapore and Dacca Districts. While this double dose of repression was being administered, no steps were taken to punish the officials responsible for the happenings at Chittagong, Hijli and Dacca, nor was any compensation or relief given to the sufferers. To add to the unrest, during the period of truce, some revolutionary prisoners were condemned to death and hanged. The vicious circles of official repression—revolutionary terrorism[1]—official counter-terrorism—thus went on. A further complication arose when the Calcutta Municipal Corporation passed a resolution[2] expressing grief at the execution of one of the revolutionary prisoners, Dinesh Chandra Gupta. In the midst of this turmoil the position of the Congress in Bengal was unenviable. Theoretically there was peace between the Government and the people, but in reality the relations were strained and there were 'hostilities' on both sides. To consider the situation a special session of the Bengal Provincial Conference was held at Berhampore in December. The Conference resolved that the Government had virtually violated the Delhi Pact and the Congress should, therefore, formally give notice to the Government and revive the civil-disobedience campaign, emphasis being laid on the boycott of British goods. It was hoped that the revival of the civil-disobedience movement would divert the energy of the youths and thereby help to stop the terrorist campaign in the province.

But the trouble was not only in Bengal. During the absence of the Mahatma from India a crisis had arisen in the Frontier Province, and also in the United Provinces. The official complaint was that the Red Shirt Volunteers[3] of the Frontier leader, Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan, were engaged in subversive activities, though as a matter of fact they were perfectly non-violent. No notice was sent to the Congress headquarters about this complaint. Suddenly an ordinance was issued declaring the Red Shirt Volunteers an illegal body. Simultaneously Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan, the Frontier Gandhi, and his brother, along with some other leaders, were put under arrest and taken to distant prisons.

[1] In December 1931, two schoolgirls named Shanti and Suniti, shot dead the Magistrate of Comilla

[2] This resolution was resented by the Government as well as by all Britishers.

[3] These volunteers were so called from the colour of their uniform. They were Congress volunteers and had nothing to do with the Communist Party.